

PHD RESEARCH PROPOSAL
Community Gardens and Urban Belonging
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RESEARCH QUESTION

How do community gardens shape a sense of belonging among the people who use them?

BACKGROUND

Community gardens are small shared plots where neighbours grow food and flowers. They are often described as sites of social capital, but we know less about the everyday practices - watering rotas, tool-sharing, disputes - through which belonging is actually built.

DESIGN

A comparative ethnography of three gardens, combining participant observation, semi-structured interviews with ~30 participants, and analysis of garden documents.

CONTRIBUTION

The thesis links theories of social capital and place-attachment to the concrete, negotiated work of tending a shared space.

(Sample document generated for demonstration. No real data.)